LESSON 1

Hot Cross Buns

A street cry: bakers sang it in London on Good Friday to sell their spiced buns. It was written down in 1733.

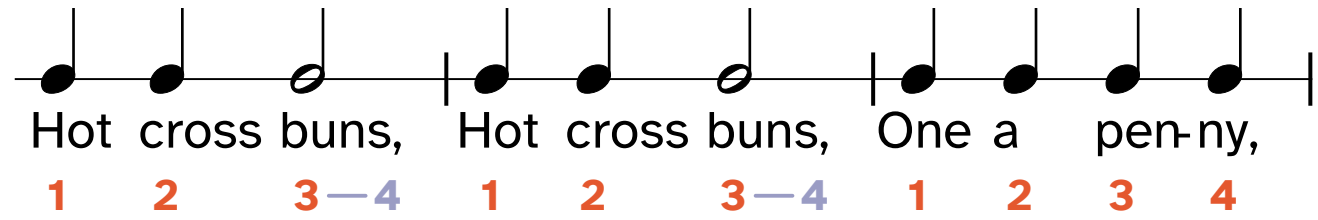
IN THIS SONG **three notes: E D C** **steps down** **crotchet and minim** **fingers 3 2 1**

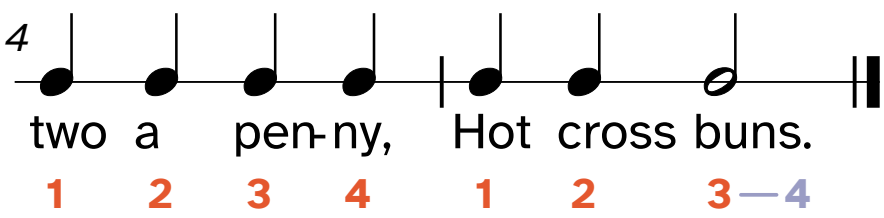
1 Say and clap

Say the words in time, then clap them and count: clap on the coral numbers, hold through the grey ones.

THE BEAT **Count 1 2 3 4** in every bar, steady as a clock.
A bar is the space between two bar lines.

THE NOTES **crotchet** 1 beat ● **minim** 2 beats ●●





☐ Said it in time ☐ Clapped and counted ☐ Found every minim (2 beats)

2 Listen and sing

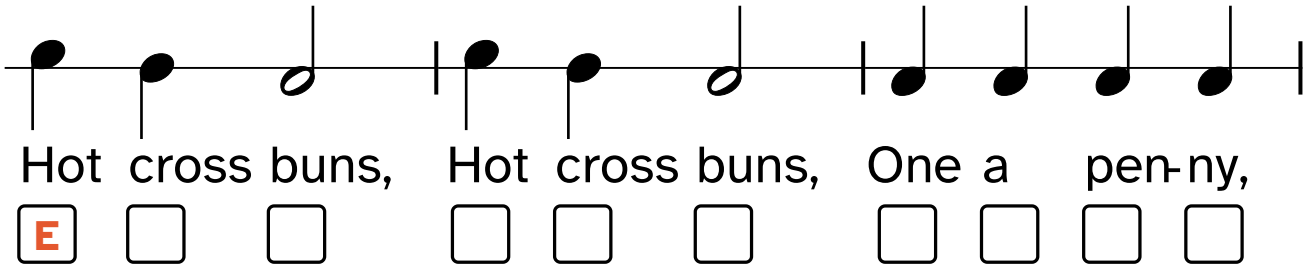
Listen first, pointing to each note as it sounds. Then sing. Write the letter name of every note in the boxes; the first one is done.

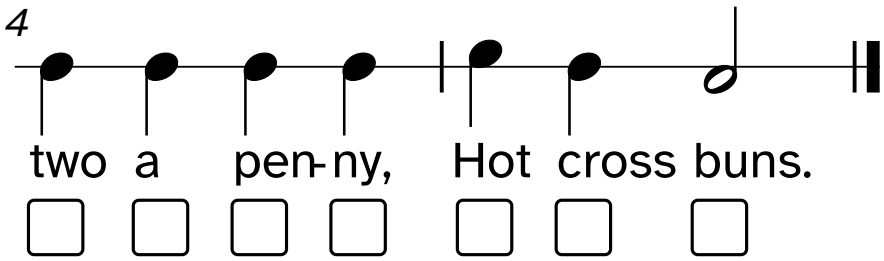


middle C

Your hand. Right thumb (1) on middle C, fingers 2 and 3 on D and E.

Steps down. Each note is the next key down: E, D, C. On the page each note sits a step lower: above the line, on it, below it.



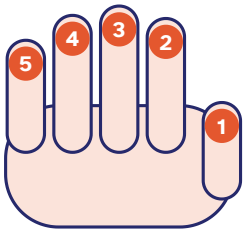


- ☐ Listened and pointed
- ☐ Sang it with the words
- ☐ Wrote the letter names
- ☐ Sang it on E D C

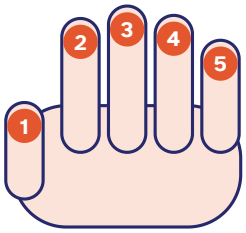
SCAN ME

3 Hello, piano

Three things every pianist knows. Read them with your teacher, then try each one.



LEFT HAND

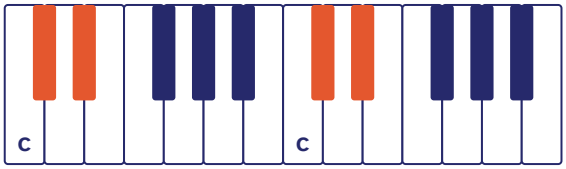


RIGHT HAND

Your fingers have numbers

Thumbs are 1, little fingers are 5, in both hands. Hold your hands up and wiggle each number your teacher calls.

- [ ] **Wiggled 1 to 5, each hand**



Black keys come in twos and threes

Play every group of two black keys, low to high, then every group of three. C is the white key just left of each two.

- [ ] **Found the twos and threes**
- [ ] **Found every C**

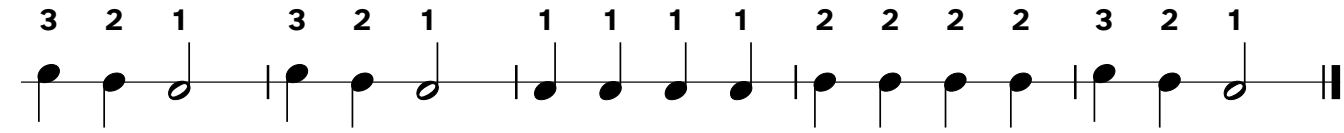
Sit like a pianist

Sit on the front half of the bench, feet flat. Elbows a little in front of you, level with the keys. Round hands, as if holding a small ball.

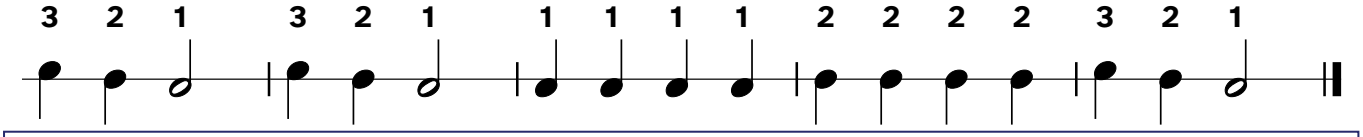
4 Play it

First on the three black keys, from the top one down: fingers 3, 2, 1. Then the same on E, D and C. Then try your left hand: thumb on E, then 2 on D, 3 on C.

RIGHT HAND · THREE BLACK KEYS



RIGHT HAND · E D C



5 · CHECK

- [ ] **I can say and clap it**
- [ ] **I can sing it with the words**
- [ ] **I can name its notes**

I can play it:

- [ ] **Black keys**
- [ ] **E D C**
- [ ] **Left hand**

TEACHER [ ] **Pass** [ ] **Not yet**